

SOP Manual — Full-Service Hotel & Resort (India)

Oct 6, 2026 · @AP

How to use this manual

This manual sets the standard operating procedures (SOPs) for a 4–5 star full-service hotel or resort in India, covering 14 departments and every recurring task they own. Each department section has four parts: purpose and scope, the SOPs (numbered steps), standards and KPIs, and a RACI matrix. Smaller properties should merge roles rather than drop steps.

SOP numbering. Every SOP has a code: **DEPT-NN** (for example, **F0-03** is the third Front Office SOP). Cite the code in training records, audits and incident reports.

RACI legend.

Letter	Meaning	Rule
R	Responsible: does the work	At least one per task
A	Accountable: signs off, owns the outcome	Exactly one per task
C	Consulted: gives input before the work	Two-way communication
I	Informed: told after the work	One-way communication

Where one person is both doing and signing off, the cell reads **A/R**.

Document control.

- Owner: General Manager (GM); custodian: Quality / Training Manager.
- Review: every 12 months, or within 30 days of a law change, an audit finding, a serious incident or a brand-standard update.
- Each department head signs a read-and-understood log for their section; every staff member signs for the SOPs they perform.
- Version history is kept on the last page of the printed master copy; uncontrolled printouts expire after 30 days.

Hierarchy of rules. Law overrides brand standards; brand standards override this manual; this manual overrides local habit. Where a state rule differs (excise, fire, shops and establishments), the state rule applies and the department head records the variance.

Regulatory and licensing framework (India)

A hotel in India operates under roughly 25 licences and registrations; five rules drive most daily SOPs: FSSAI food safety, Form C for foreign guests, GST by room tariff, voluntary service charge, and the DPDP data rules. Verify each item with your state authority and legal counsel before relying on it; thresholds and rates change.

Area	Rule that shapes the SOPs	Owner
Food safety licence	FSSAI Central licence for 5-star and above; State licence for other hotels above ₹12 lakh turnover (FSSAI). Annual return (Form D1) by 31 May.	Executive Chef / GM
Food Safety Supervisor	At least one FoSTaC-certified supervisor per 25 food handlers, per premises (FSSAI FoSTaC)	Executive Chef, HR
Menu display	Central-licence holders and chains with 10+ outlets must show kcal per serving, serving size, allergens and veg/non-veg logo on menus (FSS Labelling & Display Regs 2020)	F&B Manager
Foreign guests	File Form C (now Form-III) on the Bureau of Immigration portal within 24 hours of arrival; since the Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025, OCI holders are included (India.gov.in , NRI Information). Keep Form B guest registers.	Front Office Manager
GST on rooms	From 22 Sep 2025: tariff up to ₹7,500/night = 5% without ITC; above ₹7,500 = 18% with ITC (CA Rajput)	Financial Controller
GST on F&B	Restaurants in non-specified premises 5% without ITC; in specified premises (room value above ₹7,500) 18% with ITC (Disytax). Banquets and venue hire are taxed separately.	Financial Controller
Service charge	Cannot be added by default; must be shown as voluntary; no denial of service for refusing; no GST on it. Upheld by Delhi HC, 28 Mar 2025 (Mondaq)	F&B Manager, Finance

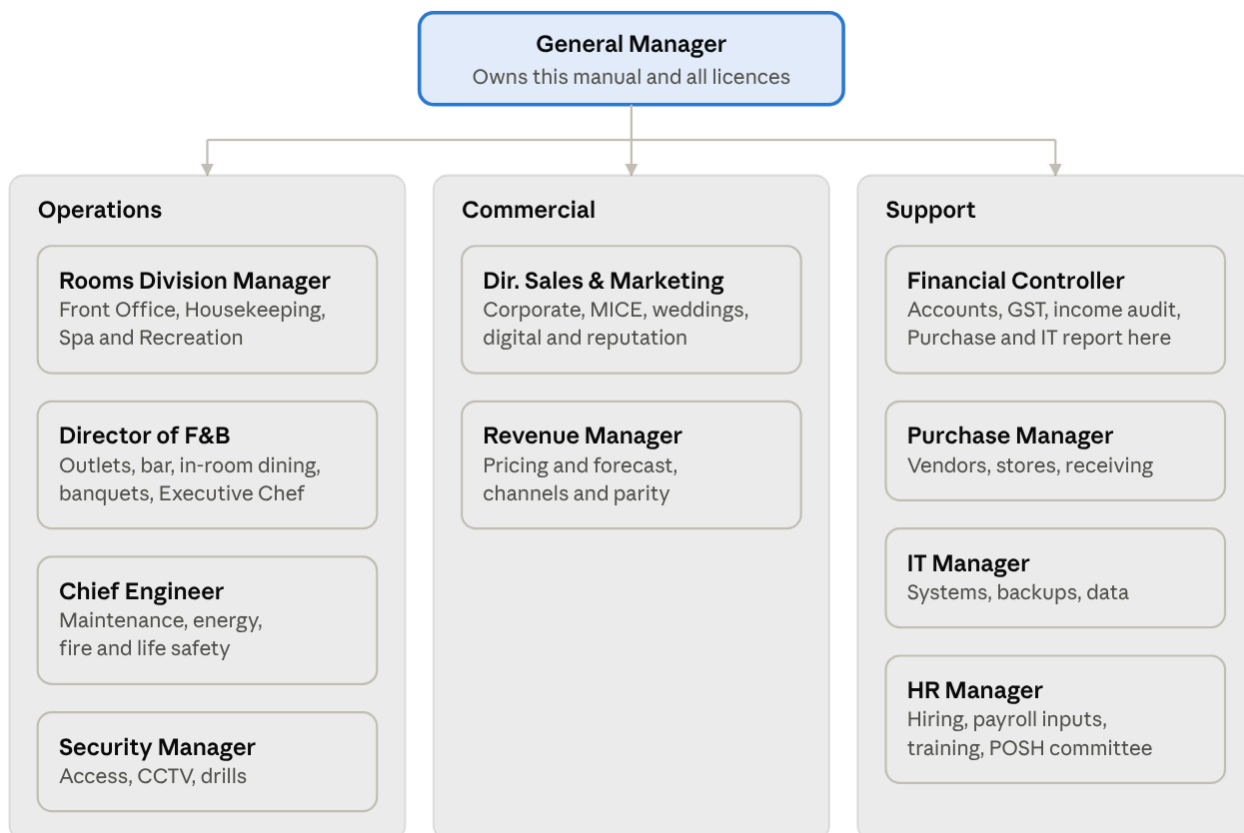
Area	Rule that shapes the SOPs	Owner
Data protection	DPDP Rules notified 13 Nov 2025; operational duties (notice, consent, security, breach reporting, erasure) bind from May 2027 (Uniquis)	IT Manager, GM
Labour	Four Labour Codes effective 21 Nov 2025, replacing 29 Acts; Central Rules in force from 8 May 2026; state rules vary (iPleaders , Lexplosion)	HR Manager
Fire safety	Fire NOC from state fire services, renewed per state cycle; design to National Building Code 2016 Part 4	Chief Engineer
Liquor	State excise licences (bar, permit room, banquet/occasional, minibar), dry-day compliance, stock registers	F&B Manager, Finance
Other licences	Shops & Establishments registration, trade/health licence, police eating-house licence (where applicable), lift licence, SPCB consent to operate, Legal Metrology, music licences (PPL/IPRS), signage, generator/diesel storage, swimming pool licence	GM (master register)
Classification	Ministry of Tourism (HRACC) star classification is voluntary but needed for a star-based FSSAI category	GM
Workplace harassment	POSH Act 2013: Internal Committee where 10+ employees, annual report to District Officer	HR Manager

The GM keeps one master licence register with licence number, issuing authority, expiry date, renewal owner and a 90-day reminder. Section "Compliance calendar and audit checklist" lists the recurring dates.

Organisation structure and role glossary

The GM is accountable for the property; department heads sit in three groups and own their section of this manual.

Every department head reports to the General Manager



hotel reporting structure · 3 groups, 11 department heads

In properties under 100 rooms, the Rooms Division Manager often also runs Front Office, Finance covers HR administration, and the Chief Engineer covers Security. The Manager on Duty (MOD) is a rotating senior manager who holds the GM's authority out of hours.

Abbreviation	Role
GM	General Manager
MOD / DM	Manager on Duty / Duty Manager
FOM / AFOM	Front Office Manager / Assistant
GSA	Guest Service Associate
EHK	Executive Housekeeper
DFB	Director of Food & Beverage
EC / EXS / CDP	Executive Chef / Executive Sous Chef / Chef de Partie
FSS	Food Safety Supervisor (FoSTaC-certified)

Abbreviation	Role
CE	Chief Engineer
SM (Security)	Security Manager
DOSM	Director of Sales & Marketing
RM	Revenue Manager
FC	Financial Controller
HRM	HR Manager
ITM	IT Manager
HOD	Head of Department

Front Office and Reservations (FO)

Front Office owns the guest's record from first enquiry to final folio, and every arrival must be registered, identity-verified and (for foreign nationals) reported on Form C within 24 hours.

Scope: reservations, arrivals, in-house services, cashiering, departures, night audit, concierge, bell desk, telephone/guest services, guest relations.

SOPs

FO-01 Reservation handling

1. Answer within 3 rings; greet with property name and own name.
2. Capture name, dates, room type, number of guests, rate code, arrival time, contact, special requests and billing instructions.
3. Quote the best available rate per Revenue's rate rules; state whether tax is included and the cancellation policy.
4. Take a guarantee: card pre-authorisation, advance deposit or company letter.
5. Read back the details; send written confirmation within 1 hour with a confirmation number.
6. Record the guest's marketing and data-use consent separately from booking terms (DPDP).
7. Amend or cancel only on the guest's or booker's written request; issue a cancellation number.

FO-02 Pre-arrival preparation

1. By 14:00 the day before, print or review the arrivals list; flag VIPs, repeat guests, groups, early arrivals and special requests.
2. Pre-block rooms by preference; send the list to Housekeeping, F&B (amenities) and Security (VIP/high-profile).
3. Prepare key cards and registration cards for confirmed early arrivals.

FO-03 Check-in and registration

1. Greet within 30 seconds of arrival; offer a welcome drink where the brand standard requires.
2. Verify identity: Indian guests show government photo ID; foreign guests show passport and valid visa. Scan and store in the PMS only; no photocopies in drawers.
3. Complete the registration card (Form B register fields): name, nationality, address, arrival from, next destination, purpose of visit, signature.
4. Confirm rate, departure date and payment method; take a card pre-authorisation or cash deposit to the house policy.
5. Explain breakfast, Wi-Fi, check-out time and safety features; hand over keys in a folder, never announcing the room number aloud.
6. Offer luggage assistance; the bell desk escorts and orients the guest.
7. For foreign nationals and OCI holders, file Form C on the Bureau of Immigration portal within 24 hours; log the acknowledgement number.

FO-04 Room move, extension and early departure

1. Check availability and rate; get the guest's agreement in writing for any rate change.
2. Issue new keys and void old ones; inform Housekeeping, Bell Desk, Telephone and F&B (in-room orders).
3. Update the PMS and Form C details if dates change.

FO-05 Guest requests and complaints (front-line)

Use the LEARN model: Listen, Empathise, Apologise, React, Notify. Log every complaint in the guest-incident system. The Duty Manager handles any complaint not resolved in 15 minutes. Service-recovery allowances follow the authority matrix in section "Cross-department SOPs".

FO-06 Cashiering and folio control

1. Post all charges to the folio the same shift; vouchers from outlets reach the desk within 30 minutes.
2. Accept only listed payment modes; follow card-security rules (PCI DSS); no card numbers written down.

3. Foreign exchange only where the hotel holds an RBI-authorised money-changer licence; record on the prescribed form.
4. Cash float counted and signed at each shift change; variances above ₹500 reported to the Front Office Manager.

FO-07 Check-out

1. The night before, deliver or email the draft folio for express checkout guests.
2. At departure, confirm late charges (minibar, laundry, outlets) with Housekeeping and outlets.
3. Present the folio; settle and print a GST-compliant invoice with GSTIN, HSN/SAC and tax split.
4. Collect keys; ask for feedback; offer luggage and transport help.
5. Update room status to vacant-dirty immediately; report Form C departure where required.

FO-08 Night audit

1. Post room and tax charges; run no-show and cancellation routines per guarantee policy.
2. Reconcile outlet revenue against POS reports, cashier reports and card settlements.
3. Check rate discrepancies, complimentary and house-use rooms against approvals.
4. Run the system day-end; back up and distribute the flash report (occupancy, ADR, RevPAR, revenue by department) by 07:00.

FO-09 Concierge and bell desk

1. Keep a verified directory of transport, restaurants, attractions, hospitals and pharmacies.
2. Book only licensed vendors; log every booking and commission.
3. Luggage: tag, log and store in a locked room; release only against the tag stub and ID.

FO-10 Key control

1. Key cards encoded only at check-in or on verified request; ask for ID before issuing a duplicate.
2. Master and emergency keys signed out on the key register; audited daily by Security.

FO-11 Lost and found (handover from Housekeeping)

Items are logged, held for 90 days (perishables 24 hours, valuables in the safe) and released against ID and signature.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Check-in time (pre-registered guest)	≤ 3 minutes
Check-out time	≤ 3 minutes
Form C filed	100% within 24 hours
Folio accuracy (disputed charges)	< 0.5% of folios
Phone answered	Within 3 rings
Upsell conversion at arrival	Set by Revenue each quarter

RACI — Front Office

Roles: FOM = Front Office Manager, AFOM = Assistant FOM / Duty Manager, GSA = Guest Service Associate, RES = Reservations Manager, NA = Night Auditor, CON = Concierge / Bell Captain, RM = Revenue Manager, FC = Financial Controller.

Activity	FOM	AFOM	GSA	RES	NA	CON	RM	FC
Take and confirm reservation	I	I	R	A	-	-	C	-
Set rates and restrictions	C	-	I	C	-	-	A/R	I
Pre-arrival room blocking	A	R	R	C	-	-	-	-
Check-in and ID verification	A	R	R	-	-	I	-	-
File Form C	A	R	R	-	R	-	-	-
Resolve guest complaint	A	R	R	-	-	C	-	I
Folio posting and settlement	A	C	R	-	C	-	-	C
Night audit and flash report	I	C	-	-	R	-	I	A
Concierge bookings	A	I	-	-	-	R	-	-
Key control audit	A	R	C	-	C	-	-	-
Lost and found release	A	R	R	-	-	C	-	-

Housekeeping and Laundry (HK)

Housekeeping delivers a clean, safe, inspected room by 14:00 and keeps room status in the PMS accurate to the minute.

Scope: guest rooms, public areas, back-of-house, linen and uniform rooms, laundry, horticulture, pest control coordination, lost and found.

SOPs

HK-01 Shift start and room allocation

1. Morning briefing at 08:00: occupancy, VIPs, departures, special requests, safety notice of the day.
2. Floor supervisor allocates rooms by credits (departure = 1.5, stayover = 1, VIP = 2); a room attendant carries 14–16 credits per 8-hour shift.
3. Attendants collect master keys against signature, a stocked trolley and the room-status sheet.

HK-02 Departure room cleaning (sequence)

1. Knock three times, announce "Housekeeping"; wait 10 seconds; repeat once. Never enter a room showing Do Not Disturb.
2. Open curtains and windows; switch on all lights to check bulbs; note damage and left items.
3. Strip linen; remove trash; check under bed and in drawers for lost property.
4. Clean top to bottom, dry to wet: dust, wipe high-touch points (switches, remotes, handles, phone), mirrors, furniture.
5. Bathroom: apply cleaner, toilet last with a dedicated red cloth and colour-coded gloves; replace glasses with sanitised, sealed ones.
6. Make bed to the brand standard; replenish amenities, stationery and minibar list.
7. Vacuum from the far corner toward the door; final check with the room checklist; set lights and AC to the welcome setting.
8. Update PMS status to "clean, awaiting inspection".

HK-03 Stay-over room service

Tidy, make bed, change towels on request (green-card programme), replenish, remove trash; the guest's belongings are never moved more than needed to clean, and documents are never touched.

HK-04 Room inspection and release

1. Supervisor inspects 100% of departures and VIP rooms, and 20% of stayovers against a 60-point checklist.
2. Fails go back to the attendant with a defect note; pass changes status to "vacant-inspected".
3. Housekeeping Manager spot-checks 5 rooms per floor per day.

HK-05 Turndown service

Between 18:00 and 21:00: close curtains, turn down bed, place bedside mat and slippers, replenish water and towels, set the night light.

HK-06 Public area cleaning

Lobby, washrooms and lift lobbies follow an hourly checklist signed on the back of the door; washrooms are checked every 30 minutes in peak hours.

HK-07 Deep cleaning and preventive maintenance rota

Each room gets a quarterly deep clean (carpet shampoo, upholstery, mattress turn, high dusting, grout); defects found go to Engineering as work orders.

HK-08 Linen and uniform control

1. Par stock = 4–5 sets per bed (one in room, one in laundry, one in floor pantry, one or two in store).
2. Soiled linen counted at the floor and at the laundry; discrepancies reported daily.
3. Condemned linen recorded, converted to rags or disposed of with Finance approval.
4. Monthly linen inventory with Finance.

HK-09 Laundry operations

1. Sort by fabric and soil level; stained items pre-treated.
2. Wash programmes per chemical supplier's chart; follow temperatures for disinfection (linen from medical incidents washed separately at high temperature).
3. Guest laundry: count in front of the guest or on the laundry list; return within 8 hours (express 4 hours); damage claims follow the liability limit printed on the list.

HK-10 Lost and found

Log with date, time, location, finder and description; valuables sealed and lodged with Security; hold 90 days, then dispose of per the GM's written policy.

HK-11 Chemical safety

Only supplier-approved, labelled chemicals; Safety Data Sheets kept in each store; dilution by dispensers; PPE (gloves, goggles) when using concentrates; never mix chlorine and acids.

HK-12 Pest control

Licensed pest-control contractor on a monthly schedule plus call-outs; sightings logged and reported to the Executive Housekeeper and Chef within 1 hour; service reports filed for FSSAI audit.

HK-13 Room status discrepancy

At 11:00 and 17:00, Housekeeping reports physical status; Front Office reconciles against the PMS; any "sleeper" or "skipper" is escalated to the Duty Manager.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Departure clean time	30–40 minutes
Rooms ready by 14:00	≥ 95%
Inspection pass rate first time	≥ 90%
Guest cleanliness score	≥ 4.6 / 5
Linen loss	< 1% per month
Laundry turnaround	8 hours standard

RACI — Housekeeping

Roles: EHK = Executive Housekeeper, AEH = Assistant Housekeeper, FS = Floor Supervisor, RA = Room Attendant, PA = Public Area Attendant, LM = Laundry Manager, FO = Front Office, ENG = Engineering.

Activity	EHK	AEH	FS	RA	PA	LM	FO	ENG
Room allocation	A	R	R	I	–	–	I	–
Clean departure room	A	C	C	R	–	–	I	–
Room inspection and release	A	R	R	I	–	–	I	–
Room status reconciliation	A	R	C	–	–	–	R	–
Public area cleaning	A	C	C	–	R	–	–	–
Deep cleaning rota	A	R	R	R	R	–	–	C
Raise maintenance defects	A	C	R	R	R	–	–	I
Linen par and inventory	A	R	C	–	–	R	–	–
Guest laundry	I	–	–	–	–	A/R	C	–
Lost and found	A	R	R	R	R	–	C	–
Pest control coordination	A/R	C	I	–	–	–	–	C

F&B Service: outlets, in-room dining, bar and minibar (FB)

F&B Service turns kitchen output into revenue at the table, and every bill must be accurate, GST-correct and free of any default service charge.

Scope: all-day dining, specialty restaurants, lobby lounge, bar, in-room dining (IRD), minibar, pool bar, breakfast operations.

SOPs

FB-01 Outlet opening (mise en place)

1. 60 minutes before opening: briefing on menu changes, 86'd items, VIP and allergy reservations.
2. Check table set-up, cutlery polish, linen, menus (clean, current, FSSAI licence number printed), condiments within date.
3. Check lighting, music level, AC temperature (22–24 °C) and washroom.
4. POS logged in; printer paper and card terminals tested.

FB-02 Reservation and seating

Confirm the booking with allergies and occasion; greet within 30 seconds; seat within 2 minutes; pull the chair for guests needing help; hand menus open.

FB-03 Order taking

1. Introduce the server; offer water (still/sparkling, or filtered free water) within 2 minutes.
2. Ask about allergies and dietary needs before recommending; repeat back allergy orders and mark them in the POS as "ALLERGY" so the KOT prints flagged.
3. Suggest pairings; never push alcohol to a guest showing signs of intoxication.
4. Punch the KOT immediately; never pass verbal orders to the kitchen.

FB-04 Service sequence

Serve from the right, clear from the right; ladies and elders first; check back within 2 minutes of the main course; clear only when all guests at the table have finished.

FB-05 Billing and settlement

1. Present the bill only on request (or as the guest is clearly leaving, with permission).
2. The bill shows GSTIN, SAC, rate split and FSSAI licence number; any service contribution is shown as optional and blank by default, and is never taxed.
3. Settle by the guest's chosen mode; room-charge only after checking the guest's name and room against the PMS and taking a signature.
4. Voids and discounts need a manager's POS authorisation with a reason code.

FB-06 Bar operations and responsible service

1. Serve alcohol only during excise-permitted hours and never on notified dry days.
2. Ask for ID from anyone who looks under 30; refuse service below the state's legal drinking age (it ranges from 18 to 25).
3. Pour with jiggers or calibrated dispensers (30 ml / 60 ml pegs); free pouring is not allowed.
4. Refuse service to visibly intoxicated guests; offer water and food; arrange a cab; log the incident.
5. Close: count opened bottles by weight or tenths, reconcile to POS sales, record in the excise register.

FB-07 In-room dining

1. Answer within 3 rings; take the order with room number, name check, allergies and delivery time; quote the delivery time (breakfast 20 minutes, all-day 30 minutes).
2. Tray or trolley: cloche, condiments, cutlery, napkin, bill folder; hot food above 63 °C, cold below 5 °C.
3. Knock, announce, wait; set up where the guest chooses; explain the dishes; present the bill for signature.
4. Tray collection within 45 minutes or on call; corridors cleared every 2 hours.

FB-08 Minibar

Daily check of occupied rooms; post consumption to the folio before 12:00 on departure day; rotate stock by expiry (FEFO); alcohol in minibars only where the excise licence permits.

FB-09 Breakfast buffet

Food labels with name, veg/non-veg mark and allergens; hot holding ≥ 63 °C and cold ≤ 5 °C, logged every 2 hours; sneeze guards; replenish when one-third full; discard at the 4-hour mark.

FB-10 Guest complaint about food

Apologise, remove the dish, inform the chef immediately; for illness or foreign-matter complaints, retain the sample, record batch details and escalate to the F&B Manager and Executive Chef within 15 minutes.

FB-11 Outlet closing

Close all checks; run the Z-report; reconcile cash and cards; lock the liquor; switch off non-essential equipment; complete the closing checklist and log book.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Greet to seat	≤ 2 minutes
Order to first course	≤ 15 minutes
IRD delivery (all-day)	≤ 30 minutes
Beverage cost %	Set per outlet (typically 18–25%)
Liquor variance	< 2% per month
Bill errors	< 0.5% of covers

RACI — F&B Service

Roles: DFB = Director of F&B, OM = Outlet Manager, CAP = Captain / Supervisor, STW = Steward / Server, BM = Bar Manager, BT = Bartender, IRD = In-Room Dining Manager, EC = Executive Chef.

Activity	DFB	OM	CAP	STW	BM	BT	IRD	EC
Menu design and pricing	A	R	C	–	C	–	C	R
Outlet opening checklist	I	A	R	R	–	–	–	–
Allergy order handling	I	A	R	R	–	–	R	C
Billing and void approval	I	A/R	R	R	–	–	–	–
Responsible alcohol service	I	C	R	R	A	R	R	–
Liquor stock and excise register	A	C	–	–	R	R	–	–
IRD order to delivery	I	–	R	R	–	–	A	C
Minibar posting	I	–	–	R	–	–	A	–
Buffet temperature log	I	A	R	R	–	–	–	C
Food complaint escalation	I	A	R	R	–	–	R	R
Outlet closing and Z-report	I	A	R	R	R	R	–	–

Banqueting and Events (BQ)

Every event runs off one signed Banquet Event Order (BEO), issued at least 72 hours before the event, and no change is made after that without a signed amendment.

Scope: weddings, conferences, social events, outdoor catering, exhibitions, MICE groups.

SOPs

BQ-01 Enquiry to contract

1. Log every enquiry in the sales system within 2 hours; reply with availability and indicative packages within 24 hours.
2. Site inspection with the client; place a tentative hold with an option date (usually 7 days).
3. Issue the contract with menu packages, minimum guarantee, attrition and cancellation terms, payment schedule (typically 25% at signing, 50% at 30 days, balance 72 hours before), GST treatment and licence needs.
4. Convert to definite only on signed contract and first deposit.

BQ-02 Licences and permissions per event

Check and obtain: occasional liquor licence (state excise) for each function serving alcohol; police permission for loud music past local limits; PPL/IPRS/Novex music licence for recorded or live music; fire safety check for stage, pyrotechnics or cold fire; outdoor-venue noise rules (night-time limits under the Noise Pollution Rules 2000).

BQ-03 Banquet Event Order

The BEO lists: date, timings, venue, set-up style and plan, final guarantee, menu with allergen notes, beverages, AV, décor, vendors, billing instructions, contact person. It is circulated to Kitchen, Stewarding, Engineering, Security, Housekeeping, Front Office and Finance; each department head signs the distribution sheet.

BQ-04 Final guarantee

The client confirms numbers 72 hours before; the hotel prepares for guarantee + 5%; billing is on guarantee or actual covers, whichever is higher.

BQ-05 Set-up and pre-event check

1. Set-up complete 2 hours before guest arrival.
2. Banquet Manager walk-through with the checklist: layout, emergency exits clear (minimum 1.5 m aisles), AV test, lighting, AC, signage, washrooms.
3. Briefing for service staff 45 minutes before: menu, allergies, sequence, timings, VIPs, emergency assembly point.

BQ-06 Event service

Buffet temperature logs every hour; plated service in synchronised sequence; one captain per 50 covers and one server per 20 covers (buffet) or per 10 covers (plated); bar per responsible service rules in FB-06.

BQ-07 Vendor management at events

Outside vendors (décor, DJ, photographers) sign the vendor undertaking: insurance, electrical safety, no open flame without approval, load-in and load-out times, damage liability. Engineering supervises all electrical connections.

BQ-08 Post-event

Close the bill within 24 hours; client signs the cover count; collect feedback within 48 hours; debrief notes logged; damages billed with photographs.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Enquiry response	≤ 24 hours
BEO issued	≥ 72 hours before the event
Set-up complete	2 hours before guest arrival
Client satisfaction	≥ 90% "would rebook"
Banquet food cost %	Set per package

RACI — Banqueting

Roles: DFB = Director of F&B, BQM = Banquet Manager, CSM = Catering Sales Manager, CAP = Banquet Captain, EC = Executive Chef, CE = Chief Engineer, SEC = Security Manager, FC = Financial Controller.

Activity	DFB	BQM	CSM	CAP	EC	CE	SEC	FC
Enquiry, proposal and contract	A	C	R	-	C	-	-	C
Event licences and permissions	A	R	R	-	-	C	C	I
Prepare and circulate BEO	I	A	R	I	C	I	I	I
Final guarantee and menu	I	A	R	-	R	-	-	I
Set-up and walk-through	I	A	I	R	-	R	C	-
Event service	I	A	I	R	R	-	I	-
Outside vendor control	I	A	C	R	-	R	R	-
Billing and collection	I	C	R	-	-	-	-	A
Post-event feedback	I	A	R	C	C	-	-	-

Kitchen and Culinary (KT)

The kitchen runs a documented Food Safety Management System (FSMS) per FSSAI Schedule 4, with critical temperatures logged at every control point and at least one FoSTaC-certified Food Safety Supervisor on every shift.

Scope: main kitchen, outlet kitchens, banquet kitchen, butchery, bakery and pastry, cold kitchen (garde manger), staff cafeteria, stewarding.

Critical limits used throughout

Control point	Limit
Chilled receiving and storage	$\leq 5^{\circ}\text{C}$
Frozen receiving and storage	$\leq -18^{\circ}\text{C}$
Cooking core temperature (poultry, minced meat, reheated food)	$\geq 75^{\circ}\text{C}$
Hot holding	$\geq 63^{\circ}\text{C}$
Cooling cooked food	60 °C to 21 °C within 2 hours, then to 5 °C within 4 more hours
Danger zone exposure	Discard after 4 hours cumulative between 5 °C and 63 °C
Thawing	In the chiller at $\leq 5^{\circ}\text{C}$, never at room temperature

SOPs

KT-01 Personal hygiene and health

1. Annual medical fitness certificate for every food handler (Schedule 4); typhoid vaccination per local advice.
2. Clean uniform, hair net, no jewellery except a plain band, short unpolished nails.
3. Handwash for 20 seconds on entry, after raw food, waste, phone, toilet, touching face.
4. Any staff with vomiting, diarrhoea, fever, jaundice or infected cuts reports to the sous chef and is kept off food work.

KT-02 Receiving

1. Check the vehicle, packaging, label (FSSAI number, batch, use-by), and probe the temperature.

2. Reject anything outside limits, damaged or without a label; note the rejection on the GRN.
3. Move chilled and frozen goods into storage within 15 minutes.

KT-03 Storage

FEFO rotation; label every opened or prepped item with name, date, time, use-by and initials; raw meat below cooked and ready-to-eat food; veg and non-veg segregated; 15 cm off the floor; chiller and freezer temperatures logged 3 times a day.

KT-04 Preparation and cross-contamination control

Colour-coded boards and knives (red raw meat, blue fish, green vegetables, yellow cooked, white dairy and bakery, brown root vegetables, purple allergen-free). Wash produce in potable water and sanitise in approved solution. Separate veg and non-veg prep where the menu declares pure-veg dishes.

KT-05 Allergen control

1. Each recipe card lists the allergens FSSAI requires to be declared (cereals with gluten, crustaceans, milk, eggs, fish, peanuts, tree nuts, soy, sulphites ≥ 10 mg/kg).
2. An allergy KOT is prepared by one cook with fresh tools, plated separately, and carried by hand with an allergy flag.
3. Any recipe change updates the allergen matrix and the menu before service.

KT-06 Cooking, cooling and reheating

Probe and log core temperature for high-risk items; cool in shallow trays or blast chiller; reheat once only, to ≥ 75 °C; never mix old and new batches.

KT-07 Recipe standardisation and costing

Every menu item has a standard recipe card: yield, portion weight, method, photograph, allergens, kcal per serving (for chains and Central-licence holders), and cost; recosted quarterly or when an input price moves more than 10%.

KT-08 Food sample retention

For banquets and buffets, keep 150 g of each dish in a sealed, labelled container at ≤ 5 °C for 72 hours.

KT-09 Cleaning and sanitation

Clean-as-you-go; a cleaning schedule per area (daily, weekly, monthly) signed off; exhaust hoods and filters degreased weekly, ducts professionally cleaned at least every 6 months; food-contact sanitisers at the supplier's contact time.

KT-10 Water and ice

Potable water tested at an NABL-accredited lab at least every 6 months (Schedule 4); ice machines cleaned weekly; ice handled with scoops only.

KT-11 Waste and oil management

Segregate wet, dry, hazardous waste; used cooking oil Total Polar Compounds checked and oil discarded above 25% TPC; sell used oil only to FSSAI-registered RUCO (Repurpose Used Cooking Oil) collectors; record quantities.

KT-12 Stewarding

Dish machine wash $\geq 60^{\circ}\text{C}$ and final rinse $\geq 82^{\circ}\text{C}$ (or chemical sanitising per the supplier); pot wash in three-sink sequence; breakage logged; chemical dispensing locked.

KT-13 Kitchen safety

Fire suppression over cooking ranges serviced every 6 months; Class K extinguisher at the line; gas leak detectors and manual cut-off valves tested monthly; knife and slicer training logged; first-aid kit with burn dressings.

KT-14 Internal food safety audit and FSSAI inspection

Monthly internal audit against the FSSAI checklist and an annual third-party audit; non-conformances closed within 14 days. During an FSSAI inspection, the Food Safety Supervisor accompanies the officer, provides records and signs the inspection report.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Temperature log completion	100%
Internal audit score	$\geq 90\%$
Food cost %	Set per outlet (typically 28–35%)
Ticket time (à la carte main)	≤ 15 minutes
Food safety incidents	Zero
FoSTaC coverage	1 supervisor per 25 handlers, every shift

RACI — Kitchen

Roles: EC = Executive Chef, EXS = Executive Sous Chef, CDP = Chef de Partie, COM = Commis, FSS = Food Safety Supervisor, CS = Chief Steward, PM = Purchase Manager, DFB = Director of F&B.

Activity	EC	EXS	CDP	COM	FSS	CS	PM	DFB
FSSAI licence and FSMS plan	A	R	C	-	R	-	-	I
Food handler medicals	A	R	I	I	R	I	-	-
Receiving and temperature checks	I	A	R	R	C	-	R	-
Storage and labelling	I	A	R	R	C	-	-	-
Allergen control	A	R	R	R	C	-	-	I
Recipe cards and costing	A	R	R	-	-	-	C	C
Temperature logs	I	A	R	R	R	-	-	-
Sample retention	I	A	R	R	C	-	-	-
Cleaning schedule	I	A	R	R	C	R	-	-
Water testing	A	C	-	-	R	-	-	I
Used oil and waste	I	A	R	R	C	R	-	-
Internal food safety audit	A	C	C	-	R	C	-	I

Engineering and Maintenance (EN)

Engineering keeps every life-safety system tested and every guest-reported fault fixed within 30 minutes, running from a computerised work-order and preventive maintenance (PPM) system.

Scope: electrical (HT/LT, DG sets), HVAC, plumbing, water treatment (WTP, STP, RO), lifts, boilers and calorifiers, kitchen and laundry equipment, fire systems, building fabric, energy, swimming pool plant, IT infrastructure power.

SOPs

EN-01 Work order handling

1. Every request (guest, department, inspection) is logged as a work order with priority: P1 safety/guest-in-room (respond 10 minutes), P2 guest-affecting (30 minutes), P3 routine (24 hours).
2. Technician acknowledges, attends, fixes, photographs where useful and closes with time and parts used.
3. Rooms put out of order (OOO) are reported to Front Office and Housekeeping with a return date.

EN-02 Preventive maintenance (PPM)

Each asset has a PPM schedule from the manufacturer's manual: guest rooms quarterly (taps, flush, AC filters, lights, TV, safe, door closer, smoke detector), AHUs monthly filters, chillers per OEM, kitchen equipment monthly. PPM compliance reviewed weekly by the Chief Engineer.

EN-03 Permit to work

Hot work (welding, cutting), work at height above 2 m, confined space (tanks, STP), and electrical isolation need a written permit, signed by the Chief Engineer or delegate and Security, with fire watch for hot work and lock-out/tag-out for electrical work.

EN-04 Fire and life safety systems

Test weekly: fire pump auto-start, fire alarm panel, sample detectors and call points. Test monthly: sprinkler flow switch, hydrant pressure, emergency lighting, pressurisation fans. Inspect extinguishers monthly; refill per IS 2190. Keep the Fire NOC and all test records for the fire department's renewal inspection.

EN-05 Lifts and escalators

AMC with the OEM; monthly service report; annual inspection and licence from the state Lift Inspector; rescue drill each quarter; entrapment response within 15 minutes.

EN-06 Power and DG sets

Daily log of HT/LT readings and power factor; DG sets run on load weekly; diesel stock and storage within the licensed limit (PESO where applicable); DG emission and noise compliance per the SPCB consent.

EN-07 Water management

Daily checks on WTP/RO output; chlorine residual at outlets logged; hot water stored ≥ 60 °C and delivered ≥ 50 °C to control Legionella; overhead and underground tanks cleaned every 6 months; STP output tested monthly against SPCB norms.

EN-08 Swimming pool plant

Test pH (7.2–7.8) and free chlorine (1–3 ppm) at least every 2 hours during opening; log readings; backwash per schedule; close the pool on any faecal incident or failed reading.

EN-09 Energy and sustainability

Daily meter readings; monthly energy and water per occupied room reported to the GM; targets set each year; lighting and AC set-back schedules in unsold rooms and closed areas.

EN-10 Contractor management

Contractors have valid licences (electrical contractor, lift, fire), insurance and ESI/EPF compliance for their workers; they sign in, wear ID, follow permits and are supervised.

EN-11 Statutory inspections

Pressure vessels and boilers (Indian Boiler Regulations), lifts, DG sets, earthing (annual), lightning arrestors (annual), electrical safety audit (per state Electricity Inspectorate) — dates kept in the compliance calendar.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
P1 response	≤ 10 minutes
Guest call resolution	≤ 30 minutes
PPM completion	≥ 95% on schedule
Rooms out of order	< 1% of inventory
Fire system test compliance	100%
Energy per occupied room	Annual target set by GM

RACI — Engineering

Roles: CE = Chief Engineer, AE = Assistant Engineer / Shift Engineer, TECH = Technician, HK = Executive Housekeeper, SEC = Security Manager, GM = General Manager, PM = Purchase Manager.

Activity	CE	AE	TECH	HK	SEC	GM	PM
Work order response	A	R	R	C	-	-	-
PPM schedule	A	R	R	C	-	I	-
Permit to work	A	R	R	-	R	-	-
Fire system testing	A	R	R	-	C	I	-
Lift AMC and licence	A	R	-	-	-	I	C
DG and power logs	A	R	R	-	-	-	-
Water and Legionella control	A	R	R	-	-	I	-
Pool chemistry	A	R	R	-	-	-	-
Energy reporting	R	R	-	-	-	A	-
Contractor control	A	R	-	-	R	-	C
Statutory inspections	A/R	C	-	-	-	I	-

Security, Safety and Loss Prevention (SE)

Security controls every entry point, every key and every CCTV camera, and leads the hotel's response in the first five minutes of any emergency.

Scope: access control, vehicle screening, CCTV, patrols, key control, guest safety, staff entry and exit, incident investigation, fire and evacuation drills, first aid, PSARA-licensed contract guards.

SOPs

SE-01 Perimeter and entrance screening

1. Vehicles: under-vehicle mirror check, boot check, driver log for taxis and vendor vehicles.
2. Guests and visitors: door-frame metal detector and X-ray baggage scanner at the main entrance (as per the local police advisory for the city's threat level).
3. Refuse entry to anyone carrying weapons unless licensed and lodged per house policy; inform the Duty Manager.

SE-02 Staff and vendor entry

Staff enter only by the time-office gate with ID and biometric attendance; bags checked at exit; vendors log in, receive a visitor badge and are escorted to their work area. Gate passes needed for any material leaving the hotel, signed by the department head.

SE-03 Contract guards

Use only agencies holding a PSARA licence; check guards' police verification and training certificates; supervise with daily briefings and a duty roster.

SE-04 CCTV

1. Cover entrances, lobbies, corridors, lifts, cash points, stores, car park and back-of-house; never guest rooms, washrooms or changing rooms.
2. Retain footage for at least 30 days (longer if the local police order says so).
3. Release footage only to police with a written request, or internally on the GM's approval; log each viewing and copy (DPDP-ready).

SE-05 Patrols

Hourly patrols of guest floors at night and of back-of-house areas; electronic checkpoints; report trip hazards, open doors, unattended items, smell of smoke.

SE-06 Guest room entry and welfare checks

If a DND room shows no activity for 24 hours, or a guest is unreachable on a welfare concern, the Duty Manager and Security enter together after knocking and calling; one female staff member attends for a female guest.

SE-07 Incident reporting and investigation

Every incident (theft, injury, fight, damage, medical) is logged in 1 hour on the incident form: what, where, when, who, witnesses, action taken. Serious incidents reported to the GM immediately; police informed for crimes; insurance informed within the policy's notice period.

SE-08 Fire evacuation and drills

Fire wardens named for each floor and shift; full evacuation drill every 6 months and table-top drill each quarter; assembly points marked; headcount from the in-house report and staff roster within 10 minutes.

SE-09 Medical emergency

Trained first-aiders on every shift; AED in the lobby and gym; doctor on call; ambulance route and nearest hospitals listed at the desk; record the incident and follow up with the guest.

SE-10 Bomb threat, suspicious item and security alerts

Take the call on the bomb threat checklist; do not touch suspicious items; cordon 100 m; inform police (112) and the GM; follow police instructions on evacuation.

SE-11 Death of a guest

Secure the room; call a doctor to confirm; inform police; preserve the scene; GM informs next of kin with police guidance; for foreign nationals, inform the FRRO and embassy; no media comment except through the GM.

SE-12 Loss prevention audits

Monthly surprise checks of stores, bar stock, cash floats, key registers and gate passes; findings to the GM and Financial Controller.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Incident report filed	≤ 1 hour
Evacuation drill headcount	≤ 10 minutes
CCTV uptime	≥ 99% of cameras

Measure	Target
Patrol checkpoints met	≥ 98%
First-aider coverage	Every shift

RACI — Security

Roles: SM = Security Manager, SS = Security Supervisor, GU = Security Officer / Guard, DM = Duty Manager, GM = General Manager, CE = Chief Engineer, HR = HR Manager.

Activity	SM	SS	GU	DM	GM	CE	HR
Entrance and vehicle screening	A	R	R	I	-	-	-
Staff and vendor entry	A	R	R	-	-	-	C
Contract guard compliance	A/R	C	-	-	I	-	C
CCTV operation and release	A	R	R	C	C	-	-
Patrols	A	R	R	I	-	-	-
Welfare room entry	C	R	R	A	I	-	-
Incident investigation	A	R	C	R	I	-	C
Fire drills	A	R	R	R	I	R	C
Medical emergency	C	R	R	A	I	-	-
Guest death	R	R	-	R	A	-	-
Loss prevention audits	A/R	R	-	-	I	-	-

Sales and Marketing (SM)

Sales and Marketing fills the hotel's base business through corporate, MICE, travel-trade and wedding accounts, and protects the brand in every channel, including reviews and social media.

SOPs

SM-01 Annual sales and marketing plan

Built in Q3 for the next financial year with Revenue and Finance: segment targets (room nights, ADR, revenue), account lists, trade calendar, marketing budget, digital plan. Approved by the GM and owner.

SM-02 Account management

Every key account has an owner, call plan (top-tier accounts monthly), production tracking and a yearly rate review. Sales calls are logged in the CRM within 24 hours.

SM-03 Corporate rate contracts (RFP season)

1. Respond to RFPs by the client's deadline using Revenue's approved rate grid.
2. Contract states: rate, room type, inclusions, validity, last-room availability (LRA) or not, blackout dates, cancellation, credit terms (Finance approves credit).
3. Load rates in the PMS and channel manager; Reservations confirms the loading.

SM-04 Group and MICE business

Use a group displacement analysis from Revenue before quoting; groups above 10 rooms need a signed group agreement with rooming-list deadline, cut-off date, attrition and deposit schedule.

SM-05 Travel trade and OTAs

Contracts with OTAs and wholesalers state commission, rate parity rules allowed by law, payment model and content standards; Marketing keeps listing content (photos, amenities, policies) accurate and reviewed every quarter.

SM-06 Digital marketing and website

The brand website is the direct-booking channel: booking engine tested weekly; privacy notice and cookie consent compliant with DPDP; tariffs shown with tax status; offers have terms in plain view.

SM-07 Advertising and claims

All claims must be true and provable under the Consumer Protection Act 2019 and CCPA guidelines on misleading advertisements; influencer content discloses paid partnership per ASCI guidelines.

SM-08 Online reputation

Monitor reviews daily; reply to every negative review within 24 hours and positive ones within 72 hours; never offer incentives for reviews; route service failures to the department head.

SM-09 Marketing data and consent

Send promotional messages only to guests who opted in; honour unsubscribes within 48 hours; follow TRAI DLT rules for SMS; keep consent records.

RACI — Sales and Marketing

Roles: DOSM = Director of Sales & Marketing, SM = Sales Manager, MCM = Marketing / Communications Manager, RM = Revenue Manager, GM = General Manager, FC = Financial Controller, RES = Reservations Manager.

Activity	DOSM	SM	MCM	RM	GM	FC	RES
Annual sales and marketing plan	R	C	R	C	A	C	I
Account management and calls	A	R	-	I	-	-	-
Corporate rate contracts	A	R	-	C	I	C	R
Group displacement and quote	A	R	-	R	I	-	I
OTA and trade contracts	A	R	C	R	I	C	I
Website and digital campaigns	A	C	R	C	I	-	-
Advertising claims review	A	C	R	-	C	-	-
Online reputation replies	A	-	R	-	I	-	-
Marketing consent records	A	-	R	-	I	-	C

Revenue Management and Distribution (RV)

Revenue sets every rate and restriction in one place (the RMS or PMS rate grid) and reviews pricing daily, so that no channel sells a rate Revenue has not approved.

SOPs

RV-01 Daily pricing review

1. By 10:00, review on-the-books (OTB) for the next 90 days against forecast, pickup, last year and the competitive set's rates.
2. Adjust BAR (best available rate) and restrictions (minimum length of stay, closed to arrival, stop-sell) by date.
3. Note GST thresholds: a rate near ₹7,500 moves the room and the hotel's restaurants between 5% and 18% GST, so model the effect with Finance before pricing across that line.

RV-02 Weekly revenue meeting

Attended by GM, DOSM, FOM, RM, DFB and FC: 14-day and 90-day forecast, pace, group wash, displacement, events in the city, actions. Minutes and owners recorded.

RV-03 Forecasting

Rolling 90-day forecast weekly; monthly forecast by segment for Finance by the 25th; forecast accuracy measured (target within $\pm 5\%$ at 7 days out).

RV-04 Rate loading and parity audit

Every rate change is loaded in the PMS/RMS and pushed via the channel manager; Reservations or the RM runs a parity check across the website, OTAs and GDS daily and fixes errors within 2 hours.

RV-05 Overbooking

Overbook only to the limit set by Revenue from historic no-show and cancellation data; walking a guest follows the walk procedure in section "Cross-department SOPs".

RV-06 Channel and cost-of-acquisition review

Monthly report of net revenue by channel after commission and fees; aim to shift share to direct channels.

RV-07 Total revenue (F&B, spa, events)

Revenue supports outlet pricing and banquet displacement with data on covers, average check and space yield (revenue per available square metre).

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
RevPAR index vs comp set	≥ 100
Forecast accuracy (7 days out)	$\pm 5\%$
Rate parity errors fixed	≤ 2 hours
Direct booking share	Annual target

RACI — Revenue

Roles: RM = Revenue Manager, DOSM = Director of Sales & Marketing, RES = Reservations Manager, FOM = Front Office Manager, GM = General Manager, FC = Financial Controller.

Activity	RM	DOSM	RES	FOM	GM	FC
Daily pricing and restrictions	A/R	C	I	I	I	-
Weekly revenue meeting	R	R	C	R	A	R
Forecast	R	C	C	C	A	R
Rate loading and parity	A	-	R	I	-	-

Activity	RM	DOSM	RES	FOM	GM	FC
Overbooking limit	A/R	C	I	C	I	-
Channel cost review	R	C	C	-	A	R
GST threshold pricing impact	R	I	-	-	A	R

Human Resources and Training (HR)

HR keeps the hotel staffed, trained and compliant with the four Labour Codes, and must check each state's rules, since central and state rules are still being finalised in several states.

SOPs

HR-01 Manpower planning

Annual headcount budget by department from forecast occupancy and covers; a staffing guide (for example, room attendants per occupied rooms) adjusts weekly scheduling; vacancies need GM approval.

HR-02 Recruitment and selection

1. Approved requisition, job description and pay band.
2. Source internally first, then referrals, portals and hospitality institutes (IHMs).
3. Structured interview with a scoring sheet; trade test for skilled roles (kitchen, bar, engineering).
4. Reference check and police verification before joining; medical fitness for food handlers.
5. Appointment letter stating role, pay, hours, leave and notice per the Labour Codes; no hiring of anyone under 18 in hazardous roles, and no child labour.

HR-03 Onboarding and induction

Day 1: documents, ID, uniform, locker, bank and statutory registrations (EPF, ESI where applicable, UAN). Days 1–3: induction on hotel values, fire safety, first aid basics, POSH, data protection, grooming, hygiene. Department on-the-job training with a buddy for 2 weeks, signed off with an SOP checklist.

HR-04 Training calendar

Monthly calendar of mandatory (fire, first aid, food safety, POSH, data protection), skills and leadership training; every employee gets at least 2 training hours a month; records kept per person.

HR-05 Rostering, hours and overtime

Rosters published a week ahead; daily and weekly hours, rest days, spread-over and overtime pay follow the OSH Code and the state's rules; women working night shifts only with consent and with safety and transport arrangements the law requires.

HR-06 Wages and statutory payments

Pay at least the applicable minimum or floor wage; pay by the statutory date; deposit EPF, ESI, professional tax, labour welfare fund and TDS on time; publish payslips; keep wage registers (digital allowed).

HR-07 Service charge or staff contribution distribution

Where guests voluntarily pay a service contribution, distribute it by a written, transparent formula; publish the monthly pool to staff.

HR-08 Performance management

Probation review at 3 or 6 months; annual appraisal against goals and SOP compliance; development plan for each employee.

HR-09 Discipline and grievances

Standing orders or a model conduct code per the Industrial Relations Code; written show-cause, enquiry and decision for misconduct; a Grievance Redressal Committee where the Code requires it.

HR-10 POSH

Internal Committee with an external member; policy displayed; complaints handled within the statutory timelines; annual report filed with the District Officer.

HR-11 Staff welfare and facilities

Staff cafeteria (food-safety rules apply), clean lockers and washrooms, first aid, transport for late shifts, uniforms, annual health check.

HR-12 Exit

Resignation acknowledgement, handover checklist, recovery of IDs and assets, full and final settlement within the Labour Codes' time limit (2 working days for wages on separation under the Code on Wages), gratuity where due, exit interview, experience letter.

Standards and KPIs

Measure	Target
Annual staff turnover	< 30%

Measure	Target
Training hours per employee per month	≥ 2
Statutory payment delays	Zero
Time to fill line roles	≤ 30 days
Employee engagement score	Annual target

RACI — HR

Roles: HRM = HR Manager, HRE = HR Executive, TM = Training Manager, HOD = Department Head, GM = General Manager, FC = Financial Controller, IC = Internal Committee.

Activity	HRM	HRE	TM	HOD	GM	FC	IC
Manpower budget	R	-	-	R	A	C	-
Recruitment and selection	A	R	-	R	I	-	-
Induction and onboarding	A	R	R	R	-	-	-
Training calendar	A	-	R	C	I	-	-
Rosters and overtime	C	-	-	A/R	-	I	-
Payroll and statutory deposits	R	R	-	-	I	A	-
Service contribution distribution	R	R	-	C	A	R	-
Appraisals	A	R	-	R	I	-	-
Discipline and enquiries	A	R	-	R	C	-	-
POSH complaints	I	-	-	-	I	-	A/R
Exit and settlement	A	R	-	C	-	R	-

Finance and Accounts (FN)

Finance closes the books within 5 working days of month-end, files every tax return on time, and audits daily revenue the morning after.

SOPs

FN-01 Daily income audit

By 11:00, the Income Auditor checks the night audit: room revenue against occupancy, rate variances, complimentaries, outlet Z-reports against POS, voids and discounts with approvals, card settlements, cash deposits; exceptions go to department heads the same

day.

FN-02 Cash handling and banking

General cashier receives drops in sealed envelopes with two signatures; counts under CCTV; deposits daily; petty cash on an imprest with vouchers and a ₹10,000 single-payment cap (set your own).

FN-03 Accounts receivable and credit

Credit only to approved accounts (credit application, limit, terms); city ledger invoiced within 48 hours of departure; ageing reviewed weekly; collections calls at 30, 45 and 60 days; disputes resolved within 7 days.

FN-04 Accounts payable

Three-way match: purchase order, goods receipt note (GRN), vendor invoice. Payments released on the agreed terms after approval; TDS deducted; vendor GSTINs validated and GSTR-2B matched before claiming ITC (where ITC is allowed).

FN-05 GST compliance

1. Apply the right rate per supply: room tariff slab, restaurant (specified or non-specified premises), banquet, spa, laundry, transport.
2. Track the specified-premises status each year from the previous year's room values.
3. File GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B by due dates; annual return GSTR-9 and 9C where required.
4. Keep invoice series per GSTIN; e-invoicing where turnover crosses the notified threshold.

FN-06 Payroll accounting

Payroll from HR inputs, reviewed by FC; statutory deposits (EPF, ESI, PT, LWF, TDS) on due dates; reconcile monthly.

FN-07 Month-end close

Cut-off of revenue and costs; accruals and prepayments; inventory valuation (food, beverage, general stores); fixed asset additions; reconciliations (bank, card, OTA, intercompany); P&L in USALI format with commentary by day 5.

FN-08 Budget and forecast

Annual budget built with department heads from Revenue's forecast; monthly reforecast; variance commentary over $\pm 5\%$ by line.

FN-09 Internal controls

Segregation of duties (no single person orders, receives and pays); surprise cash counts monthly; liquor and food stock counts monthly; credit card chargeback handling within the bank's window.

FN-10 Statutory audit and records

Statutory and tax audits per the Companies Act and Income-tax Act; record retention per law (books of account 8 years under the Companies Act; GST records at least 72 months after the annual return due date).

RACI — Finance

Roles: FC = Financial Controller, AM = Accounts Manager, IA = Income Auditor, GC = General Cashier, CC = Cost Controller, GM = General Manager, HOD = Department Heads.

Activity	FC	AM	IA	GC	CC	GM	HOD
Daily income audit	A	C	R	-	-	I	I
Cash and banking	A	C	-	R	-	-	-
Credit approval and collections	A	R	-	-	-	C	C
Accounts payable	A	R	-	-	C	-	C
GST filing	A	R	C	-	-	I	-
Month-end close	A	R	R	-	R	I	C
Budget and forecast	R	C	-	-	C	A	R
Stock counts and costing	A	-	-	-	R	-	C
Statutory audit	A/R	R	C	-	C	I	-

Purchase and Stores (PS)

Nothing is bought without an approved purchase requisition and order, and nothing enters stores without a receiving check against that order.

SOPs

PS-01 Vendor onboarding

Collect PAN, GSTIN, bank details (on the vendor's letterhead), FSSAI licence for food vendors, trade licences, MSME status (payment within 45 days for MSME vendors under the MSMED Act); food vendors audited before approval and yearly.

PS-02 Purchase requisition and quotations

Departments raise a requisition in the system; Purchase gets three quotations for non-contracted items above ₹25,000 (set your own limit); comparative statement approved per the authority matrix.

PS-03 Purchase orders and rate contracts

Perishables on weekly or fortnightly rate contracts; dry goods monthly; capital items need a capex approval.

PS-04 Receiving

Receiving clerk checks quantity (weigh or count), quality (with the chef for food), temperature, labels and expiry; signs the GRN; rejects with a credit note; receiving hours fixed (for example 07:00–14:00).

PS-05 Storage and issues

Stores organised by category with bin cards; FEFO; issue only against signed requisitions; liquor in a double-locked bond store with excise register.

PS-06 Par levels and inventory

Min/max par for every item; monthly physical count with Finance; slow-moving and expired stock reported; variances above 1% investigated.

PS-07 Ethics

Buyers declare conflicts of interest; no gifts above a nominal value; vendor rotation and annual review.

RACI — Purchase and Stores

Roles: PM = Purchase Manager, PO = Purchase Officer, SK = Storekeeper, RC = Receiving Clerk, EC = Executive Chef, FC = Financial Controller, HOD = Department Heads.

Activity	PM	PO	SK	RC	EC	FC	HOD
Vendor onboarding and audit	A	R	–	–	C	C	–
Requisition	I	–	–	–	–	–	A/R
Quotations and comparison	A	R	–	–	C	C	C
Purchase order	A	R	–	–	–	I	I
Receiving check	I	–	C	R	R	A	–
Storage and issues	A	–	R	–	–	I	C
Monthly inventory count	C	–	R	–	C	A	C
Liquor bond register	C	–	R	–	–	A	–

IT and Systems (IT)

IT keeps the PMS, POS, door-lock and payment systems running with tested backups, and must be ready for DPDP operational duties (notices, consent, security safeguards, breach reporting, erasure) before May 2027.

SOPs

IT-01 User access

Access by role, requested by the department head and approved by IT; unique logins, no sharing; access removed on the employee's last working day; quarterly access review.

IT-02 Backup and recovery

Daily automated backup of PMS, POS and finance systems; one copy off-site or in the cloud; restore test every quarter; recovery time target 4 hours for the PMS.

IT-03 Network and guest Wi-Fi

Guest Wi-Fi on a separate network from operations; login with OTP to a registered mobile and logs kept per DoT rules for public Wi-Fi; firewall and anti-malware updated; card systems segmented per PCI DSS.

IT-04 Personal data protection (DPDP)

1. Keep a data inventory: what guest, staff and vendor data is held, where, why and for how long.
2. Give a clear privacy notice at booking and check-in; take separate consent for marketing.
3. Contracts with processors (PMS vendor, channel manager, Wi-Fi provider, payment gateway, CRM) include security and breach-notice clauses.
4. Name a grievance contact and respond to access, correction and erasure requests within the published timeline.
5. Delete data when its purpose ends unless another law requires retention (Form C, GST, accounts).

IT-05 Cyber incident and data breach

Isolate affected systems; preserve logs; inform the GM and owner; report to CERT-In within 6 hours as its directions require; notify the Data Protection Board and affected people as the DPDP Rules require; record lessons learned.

IT-06 Downtime procedures

Manual check-in kit (registration cards, key cards pre-encoded for emergency, rate sheet, arrivals print), printed in-house list every shift, offline POS or manual KOTs; re-key all transactions within 24 hours of recovery.

IT-07 Asset and licence management

Asset register; licensed software only; patching monthly; end-of-life equipment wiped before disposal.

RACI — IT

Roles: ITM = IT Manager, ITE = IT Executive, GM = General Manager, HOD = Department Heads, FC = Financial Controller, VEN = System Vendors.

Activity	ITM	ITE	GM	HOD	FC	VEN
User access	A	R	-	R	-	-
Backup and restore test	A	R	I	-	-	C
Network and Wi-Fi	A	R	-	-	-	C
Data inventory and notices	R	C	A	C	C	C
Data rights requests	R	R	A	C	-	C
Cyber incident and breach report	R	R	A	I	I	C
Downtime procedure	A	R	I	R	-	-
Assets and licences	A	R	-	-	C	-

Spa, Recreation and Resort Activities (SP)

Every spa treatment starts with a signed health consultation form, and every activity with risk (pool, water sports, adventure, kids' club) has a trained supervisor present and a written risk assessment.

SOPs

SP-01 Spa booking and consultation

Book with treatment, therapist preference (same-gender therapist on request), time and contraindications; on arrival the guest fills the health form (pregnancy, blood pressure, allergies, recent surgery); the therapist reviews it and adapts or declines the treatment.

SP-02 Treatment hygiene

Fresh linen per guest; tools sterilised (autoclave or approved disinfectant); single-use items discarded; products within expiry; room cleaned between guests; steam, sauna and jacuzzi temperatures logged.

SP-03 Guest privacy and conduct

Draping at all times; doors closed but not locked; therapists never treat intimate areas; zero tolerance for inappropriate requests, reported to the Spa Manager and Security.

SP-04 Therapist qualifications

Recognised certification (for example, a Sector Skill Council or international qualification); records kept; Ayurveda treatments by trained practitioners; any medical claim needs proper registration.

SP-05 Gym

Induction for guests; equipment checked daily and serviced quarterly; disinfect equipment after use; under-16s supervised; posted emergency number and AED nearby.

SP-06 Pool and beach safety

Lifeguard with a valid certification on duty in opening hours; depth markings and no-diving signs; children under 12 with an adult; glassware banned on the pool deck; close the pool on lightning, failed water test or no lifeguard. Beach or water-sport activities through licensed operators with life jackets and state tourism permissions.

SP-07 Kids' club

Registration with parent's contact and allergies; child-to-staff ratio set by age (for example 1:4 under 4 years, 1:8 above); background-verified staff; signed pick-up by the registered adult only; no photographs without parental consent (DPDP rules for children's data).

SP-08 Excursions and adventure activities

Only insured, licensed vendors; signed waiver and briefing; weather check before departure; headcount out and back.

RACI — Spa and Recreation

Roles: SPM = Spa Manager, THR = Therapist, SR = Spa Receptionist, RCM = Recreation Manager, LG = Lifeguard, KCS = Kids' Club Supervisor, SEC = Security, CE = Chief Engineer.

Activity	SPM	THR	SR	RCM	LG	KCS	SEC	CE
Booking and health form	A	R	R	-	-	-	-	-
Treatment hygiene	A	R	-	-	-	-	-	-
Conduct incidents	A	R	C	-	-	-	R	-
Therapist credentials	A/R	C	-	-	-	-	-	-
Gym safety	C	-	-	A	-	-	-	R
Pool supervision	-	-	-	A	R	-	I	R
Kids' club	-	-	-	A	-	R	C	-
Excursions and vendors	-	-	-	A/R	-	-	C	-

Cross-department SOPs (XD)

These procedures cut across departments; the Duty Manager (MOD) coordinates each one until the GM or a department head takes over.

XD-01 Fire emergency

1. Whoever discovers fire: raise the alarm (call point), call the fire control room, use an extinguisher only if safe.
2. Fire control room: confirm the zone on the panel, call the fire brigade (101/112), inform the MOD and Chief Engineer.
3. Engineering: shut HVAC in the zone, start fire pumps if not auto, bring lifts to ground floor, open smoke exhaust.
4. Fire wardens: sweep the floor, evacuate by stairs, close doors behind.
5. Front Office: print the in-house list and guests needing assistance; hand to the assembly point controller.
6. Security: control entry, guide the fire brigade, keep the drive clear.
7. MOD: head count at assembly point within 10 minutes; report missing persons to the fire brigade.

XD-02 Guest complaint escalation and service recovery

Level	Who	Can offer without approval
1	Front-line staff	Apology, replacement, amenity up to ₹1,000
2	Supervisor / Outlet Manager	Waiver of one item, amenity up to ₹5,000
3	Duty Manager / Department Head	Room upgrade, one-night waiver
4	GM	Anything above level 3

All recoveries logged with cause; repeat causes reviewed in the weekly operations meeting. Set the rupee limits to suit the property.

XD-03 VIP arrival

Sales or FO flags the VIP 48 hours before; GM approves the amenity and room; HK inspects the room twice (HK Manager and FOM); Security plans the arrival for high-profile guests; GM or MOD greets; preferences logged.

XD-04 Walking a guest (overbooked)

MOD decides; book an equal or better room at a nearby hotel at the hotel's cost; pay transport; offer a call and an amenity; bring the guest back the next day if staying longer; log the cost.

XD-05 Food poisoning complaint

Record symptoms and timeline; arrange medical help; retain food samples and records; Executive Chef and FSS investigate; inform the GM; report to the local Food Safety Officer if required or if several guests are ill.

XD-06 Power failure

DG takeover within 15 seconds (auto mains failure panel); check lifts for trapped passengers; FO switches to downtime procedures if systems fail; Engineering informs the utility.

XD-07 Natural disasters (flood, cyclone, earthquake)

Follow district disaster management alerts; pre-position sandbags, fuel, water and food stock; shelter-in-place or evacuate per the authority's advice; account for all guests and staff.

XD-08 Media and crisis communication

Only the GM (or brand spokesperson) speaks to the media; staff refer all questions; holding statement within 1 hour of a serious incident; no names or details of guests ever shared.

RACI — Cross-department

Roles: GM, MOD = Manager on Duty, FOM, EHK, CE, SM = Security Manager, EC = Executive Chef, DOSM.

Activity	GM	MOD	FOM	EHK	CE	SM	EC	DOSM
Fire emergency	A	R	R	R	R	R	R	I
Complaint escalation (level 3-4)	A	R	R	C	C	-	C	I
VIP arrival	A	R	R	R	C	R	C	R
Walking a guest	I	A/R	R	-	-	-	-	I
Food poisoning complaint	A	R	C	-	-	I	R	-
Power failure	I	R	R	-	A	C	-	-
Natural disaster	A	R	R	R	R	R	R	I
Media statement	A/R	C	-	-	-	C	-	C

Compliance calendar and audit checklist

The recurring dates below are the minimum cycle; the GM adds each licence's actual expiry date from the master register.

Frequency	Task	Owner
Every arrival	Form C for foreign and OCI guests within 24 hours	FOM
Daily	Temperature logs, pool chemistry, income audit, CCTV check, parity check	EC, CE, FC, SM, RM
Weekly	Fire pump and alarm test, DG on-load run, PPM review, revenue meeting	CE, RM
Monthly	GST returns (GSTR-1, GSTR-3B), EPF/ESI/PT deposits, extinguisher check, internal food safety audit, stock counts, pest control service	FC, HRM, CE, EC
Quarterly	Lift rescue drill, room deep clean, access review, backup restore test, table-top fire drill	CE, EHK, ITM, SM
Every 6 months	Evacuation drill, water test at NABL lab, tank cleaning, kitchen exhaust duct cleaning	SM, CE, EC
Annually	FSSAI Form D1 by 31 May, POSH annual report, food handler medicals, earthing and electrical audit, lift licence, statutory audit, SOP manual review	EC, HRM, CE, FC, GM
On renewal	Fire NOC, excise licences (typically 1 April in many states), Shops & Establishments, trade/health licence, SPCB consent, music licences, FSSAI licence (1–5 years)	GM

Quarterly audit checklist (sample)

- ☐ Every licence on the master register valid for at least 60 days
- ☐ FoSTaC supervisor on every kitchen shift (1 per 25 handlers)
- ☐ Menus show FSSAI licence number; allergen and kcal display where required
- ☐ No default service charge on any bill template
- ☐ Form C acknowledgements match foreign arrivals
- ☐ Fire drill records and NOC on file
- ☐ CCTV retention of at least 30 days tested
- ☐ Privacy notice and marketing consent in booking flow
- ☐ Statutory deposits paid on time for the quarter
- ☐ POSH committee constituted and displayed

Sources

- [FSSAI FoSTaC](#)
- [FSSAI order on hotel licence categories](#)
- [FSS Labelling and Display Regulations, menu display](#)
- [Online Form C, Bureau of Immigration](#)
- [Form-III under Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025](#)
- [GST on hotel rooms from 22 Sep 2025](#)
- [GST on hotel restaurants](#)
- [Delhi HC on service charge, 28 Mar 2025](#)
- [DPDP timelines](#)
- [Labour Codes implementation](#)
- [Central Rules under the Labour Codes, 8 May 2026](#)

This manual is operational guidance, not legal advice; confirm statutory points with counsel and your state authorities.